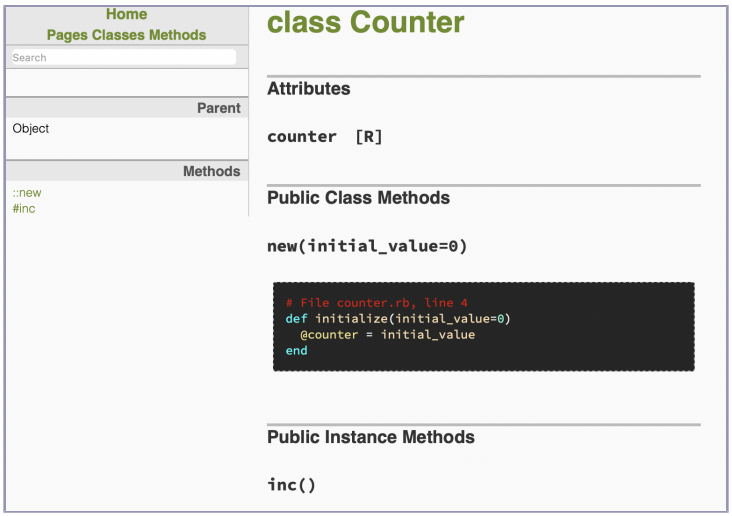


Even though the source contains no internal documentation, RDoc manages to extract interesting information from it. We have three panes at the top of the screen showing the files, classes, and methods for which we have documentation. For class Counter, RDoc shows us the attributes and methods (including the method signatures). And if we clicked a method signature, RDoc would pop up a window containing the source code for the corresponding method.

If our source code contains comments, RDoc can use them to spice up the documentation it produces. For example, the following source code:

rdoc/example_with_comments/counter.rb

```
# Implements a simple accumulator, whose
# value is accessed via the attribute
# _counter_. Calling the method Counter#inc
# increments this value.
class Counter
  # The current value of the count
  attr_reader :counter

  # create a new Counter with the given
  # initial value
  def initialize(initial_value = 0)
    @counter = initial_value
  end

  # increment the current value of the count
  def inc
    @counter += 1
  end
end
```

results in a similar RDoc page: